Thankful Hearts, Clear Steps — Speaker Notes

Friday, November 13, 2026 · 6:30–7:15 PM CT · Live on Zoom. Teaching runs about 35 minutes (slides in order), then questions to minute 45. Read the notes in your own words — they are a guide, not a script.

Slide 1 — Title / Welcome

[Minutes 0–2] Welcome everyone. Say: November is Family Caregivers Month, and tonight is for YOU — the parents and caregivers who help everyone else. Thank them for coming. Remind them: no cost, no sales pitch, and questions at the end — the ones sent in when they registered come first.

Slide 2 — Tonight's Road Map

[Minutes 2–3] Read the road map out loud so families know where the night is going. Tell them a pen and paper will help for the tips.

Slide 3 — First, a Word for YOU

[Minutes 3–6] Speak from the heart here. Many parents never hear this. Say: the best thing you can give your child is a caregiver who is still standing. Tonight we cover your child's benefits AND your own load.

Slide 4 — The Benefits Map

[Minutes 6–8] Set up the map. Say: these three get mixed up all the time. Tonight we keep it simple — what each one is and who it is for. Details for one family belong in a free first talk, not a group class.

Slide 5 — SSI in Plain Words

[Minutes 8–11] Plain words only. SSI looks at the disability AND the money side. For a child, the parents' income counts too. Never promise anyone they will be approved — SSA decides.

Slide 6 — SSDI & DAC in Plain Words

[Minutes 11–14] DAC is the one families miss most. Key line: if a parent is about to file for retirement, talk to us FIRST — the order of filings can protect the child's Medicaid. Never promise amounts; SSA decides.

Slide 7 — Which One Fits Your Family?

[Minutes 14–17] Walk through the three questions slowly. These answers point to the right door. Tell them: you do not have to figure this out alone tonight — that is what the free talk is for.

Slide 8 — Medication Help

[Minutes 17–22] This is real help families can use right away. Explain what a check is: we look at the full list, look for help programs, and show you the steps. The check itself is free for everyone.

Slide 9 — Caring for YOU: Budget Basics

[Minutes 22–27] Keep it gentle — no shame about money, ever. Share the call-companies tip: many companies have hardship or discount programs, but you have to ask. That one call can free up real

money.

Slide 10 — Asking for Help Is a Strength

[Minutes 27–30] Remind them 2-1-1 is free and local. Respite is not giving up — it is how caregivers last. Encourage one small ask this month.

Slide 11 — Your Child's Personal Plan

[Minutes 30–33] This is Southern Oak's specialty. A plan takes all the pieces families carry in their heads and puts them in order, with next steps. No prices tonight — the first talk is free and that is where we look at your family.

Slide 12 — One Small Step This Week

[Minutes 33–35] End teaching with action, not pressure. One small step this week. Then move to questions.

Slide 13 — Questions

[Minutes 35–45] Answer registered questions first, like we promise. Keep answers general. If a question needs a family's private details, invite them to the free talk instead of answering it in the group.

Slide 14 — Thank You — and Happy Thanksgiving!

[Close] Thank them warmly. Say Happy Thanksgiving. Remind them the first talk is free and there is no pressure — we are here when they are ready.